

while a roll to resist vivid, recurring nightmares relies on a dice pool solely from the Willpower Trait.

A dice pool can't draw on more than two Traits, and Traits with a maximum rating of 10 (such as Glamour, Banality, and Willpower) can't have other Traits added to their dice pool. Humans (including Enchanted humans) can never have more than 10 dice in a dice pool. Changelings wielding potent Treasures and Arts may find this limitation doesn't apply to them. Unfortunately for changelings, the same unlimited dice pool is available to other non-human entities, including the worst living nightmares from the Dreaming.

Multiple Actions

Occasionally, a character needs to perform more than one action in a turn, such as trying to bypass an electronic lock in a busy office while attempting to avoid attention, or sidestepping an incoming attack while striking the oncoming chimerical monster with a hammer. In such situations, actions can be attempted normally, though all actions become more difficult as the character's attention is split among them.

The player declares how many actions the character will take in a turn, determining which has the smallest dice pool. That many dice can then be split among the actions in proportions the player sees fit.

Example: *Your character is being interrogated by the sidhe seneschal, due to an accusation of rabble-rousing. Your eshu agitator wishes to lie, stating her innocence. As she's never trusted the seneschal's motives, she simultaneously reads the seneschal's reactions to her answers. This is a Manipulation + Subterfuge roll (for which your character has six dice) and a Perception + Empathy roll (for which your character has five dice). Five dice is the smaller dice pool, so you may divide five dice among the number of actions you want to take. That is, you may allocate these five dice as you see fit between the bald-faced lie and the interpretation of the sidhe's body language.*

At the Storyteller's discretion, certain wildly-disparate action combinations may incur a difficulty increase (see below) on top of the split dice pool limitations. Seducing a hoary old sluagh while fencing with a nocker rival is a challenge, and the difficulty will be altered to reflect that. Splitting dice pools to a certain degree may well be impossible in some cases, adjudicated by the Storyteller.

Difficulties

When a character is about to make an action and a roll is required to determine success, the Storyteller will assign a difficulty number to the action and announce it to the players. A difficulty is always a number between 2 and 10 (but generally between 3 and 9). Each time you score that number or higher on one of your dice, you've gained a success. For example, if an action's difficulty is a 6 and you roll a 3, 4, 5, 6 and 10, then you've scored two successes. Only one success is required to perform most actions successfully, but it's a marginal success. If you score three or more, it's a complete success.

The following charts should give you a good idea of how to combine difficulties and degrees of success.



Difficulties

- | | |
|---|---|
| 3 | Trivial (boiling pasta, with instructions) |
| 4 | Easy (following a trail of Glamour to a powerful chimera) |
| 5 | Straightforward (seducing a satyr) |
| 6 | Standard (training a dog — not a pooka — to sit) |
| 7 | Challenging (practicing the etiquette protocols in a foreign court) |
| 8 | Difficult (convincing an enemy combatant to stand down) |
| 9 | Extremely difficult (juggling running chainsaws) |

Degrees of Success

- | | |
|-----------------|---|
| One Success | Marginal (writing a history paper, using Wikipedia as your only source) |
| Two Successes | Moderate (convincing a dog to sit, though it won't sit for long) |
| Three Successes | Complete (eradicating a nest of vermin in your freehold) |
| Four Successes | Exceptional (performing a play well enough to earn several encores) |
| Five Successes | Phenomenal (creating a masterwork treasure, worthy of acclaim) |



Most tasks have a default difficulty of 6. If the Storyteller or rulebook ever calls for a roll, but doesn't give a specific difficulty, the task is difficulty 6.

The Storyteller is the arbiter on action difficulties, assigning a higher target number the more difficult an action is. Conversely, routinely easy tasks should have low difficulties, and where particularly simple the Storyteller may permit an automatic success. Difficulty 3 and 4 tasks are easy enough to warrant no dice rolling, unless an interesting consequence from success or failure is evident.

Be wary of assigning difficulties of 10, as the results curve is inclined to punish players with more dice to roll. A player has as good a chance to botch as to succeed, as 1s are as likely as 10s (see Botches, below). An alternative to a difficulty of 10 is setting a target difficulty of 9, but deducting dice from the player's roll.

Failure

Scoring no successes on a roll results in a failed action. The changeling fails to impress the countess. The dying words of the traveler cannot be understood. The bottle hits the road instead of the riot cop. Failure is a fantastic opportunity for